training of the best mountaineers of the regiment commenced nearly one year ahead. They trained hard in the Siachen glacier and attempted other peaks like ‘Bhagirathi’ (6,510 m) and ‘Mana’ (7,273 m). To ensure a balanced composition of the team some outstanding mountaineers from other units of the army were also included in the team. Lieutenant Colonel I.S. Thapa from 4 Maratha Light Infantry was the leader of this expedition, which had a total of twenty members. The team was flagged off on 28 March 2007 and their plan was to climb the Everest from the tougher north face, like the earlier women’s expedition of 2005. They put on the roof-top of the world a total of twelve army mountaineers and an equal number of sherpas on 15–16 May 2007. In the first successful summit attempt, Captain D.J. Singh, Subedar M. Khandagle, Havildars Tshering Angchok, Balwant Singh Negi, Amardev Bhatt and Sepoy Sachin Patil scaled the peak on the 15 May. The next day, another six climbers reached the summit. These were Havildars Nandkumar Jagtap, Dayanand Dhali, Ram Bahadur Mall, Mingmar Gurung, Tejpal Singh Negi and Khem Chand. Defence Minister A.K. Antony was there with me to flag in the expedition on 10 July 2007. I was happy that both these Everest expeditions had returned safely without any mishaps.